



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Holy Innocents Catholic School
School Website: <https://www.lbcatholicschool.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Holy Innocents Catholic School CA 90806 presents a robust Catholic, classical liberal-arts orientation across its public materials. The school emphasizes Catholic identity, formation of character, and a classical curriculum that foregrounds the liberal arts, Great Books, Latin, rhetoric, and high-level discourse. Public materials repeatedly reference Catholic liturgy, Carmelite spirituality, and partnerships with families, aligning with core elements of classical education as described in the Six Essential Elements rubric. The school's explicit framing around formation, truth-goodness-beauty, and a living, communal pedagogy supports a CLASSICAL classification across categories. Evidence from the school's site includes explicit mentions of Catholic liberal arts education, Great Works and Latin, and a pedagogy that blends memorization, singing, reading, discussion, and oration at various grade levels. The presence of liturgical practices and a strong parental-partner focus further support its classical orientation.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Key insights: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are clearly foregrounded through Catholic identity, Carmelite spirituality, and liturgical life (Mass, Eucharistic processions, and Eucharistic worship as routines). Evidence centers on daily Mass, ceremonies, and a Catholic worldview threaded through curriculum and community life. - Purpose and Goal emphasize formation, virtue, and wisdom consistent with classical aims rather than sole job preparation. Public statements articulate a transformative Catholic education and a mission framed around truth, goodness, and beauty with a strong focus on formation. - Curriculum centers on liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Latin, and Western civilization, with explicit references to Great Works of the Ancient World and Medieval & Renaissance World, indicating alignment with classical curriculum expectations. - Pedagogy includes a blend of contemplative/restful elements (memory work, chant, singing, contemplation) and Socratic-style discussion and rhetoric in upper grades, consistent with classical pedagogy expectations. - Faculty are framed as mentors and living exemplars within a community of teachers who model virtue and form the living curriculum, with explicit emphasis on devoted faculty and staff. - Parents & Community are positioned as co-educators and partners, with opportunities for parent formation, book studies, and open campus/welcoming visits. Campaigns and events further strengthen community engagement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents Catholic identity as central, referencing Catholic classical liberal arts education and Carmelite spirituality as guiding charisms. Public materials note daily Mass, Eucharistic practice, and liturgical life (e.g., morning Mass, Eucharistic processions). - Liturgical and communal practices are described as integral to education, including references to worship and sacred appointments (Mass, Eucharist,

prayer). - The mission emphasizes truth, goodness, and beauty within a Catholic framework, with explicit language about formation in a sacred context.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: truth, goodness, beauty, liturgy, Mass, sacred/tradition, theology, Carmelite spirituality, sacred community, reverence, wonder, ritual. - Negative keywords observed: none evident in public materials; no signals of relativism or secular-humanist emphasis detected in the site content. For rubric-reference, negative signals described in the classical lexicon are not evidenced in public site content. (Rubric source: Six Essential Elements lexicon; Negative signals include relativism, secular humanism, etc.)

Why this rating - The presence of Catholic liturgical life, Carmelite spirituality, and explicit references to truth, goodness, and beauty grounds this category firmly in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations with CLASSICAL orientation. The site consistently ties education to a transcendent, sacred order rather than secular humanist framing. The absence of countervailing secular narratives further supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials frame education as formation of mind and heart rather than mere information or job preparation, emphasizing transformation, virtue, and the cultivation of wisdom. The mission describes forming students in truth, goodness, and beauty through partnership with parents and a devout faculty. - Statements describe an education that seeks to form humanity and virtue, and to cultivate discernment, rather than a narrow focus on career outcomes. The phrase “transformative Catholic education” and the emphasis on “truth, goodness, and beauty” align with classical telos. - Curriculum rhetoric and program descriptions emphasize Great Works, Great Books, and a holistic formation of the person, not solely workforce readiness.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, telos, contemplation/scholé, great conversation, humane education, moral imagination, character development, sacred/tradition, love of learning. Public materials reflect several of these themes, especially formation and the telos of education. - Negative keywords observed: none overtly; public materials do not emphasize workforce preparation or job-market readiness as the primary goal. (Rubric negative signals include college/career readiness as a non-classical aim; not evident in public site content.)

Why this rating - The school’s emphasis on formation, virtue, and arch-Catholic telos, paired with a stated mission to form the whole person in truth, goodness, and beauty, supports CLASSICAL rather than information-centric or career-centric aims. The absence of job-preparatory framing reinforces CLASSICAL alignment.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Curriculum content explicitly references the liberal arts framework: grammar, logic, and rhetoric; Latin; and the artes liberales. The curriculum overview lists Great Works of the Ancient World, Western Civilization, and Latin II, as well as Rhetoric and debate components in the upper grades. This is a direct reflection of classical curriculum structure. - The program includes Great Books and Western civilization study across grade levels, as seen in the curriculum overview (Religion I: Sacred Scripture, Core 1: Great Works of the Ancient World, Western Civilization I, Rhetoric I, etc.). - The site emphasizes reading, discussion of literature, and engagement with great books and classical works (e.g., references to Dante, Paradiso, and other canonical texts in the public materials). This aligns with the Great Conversation model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, great conversation, Latin, Western civilization, history (as part of Western Civilization), sacred/tradition, contemplation/wonder, arts, music. These terms appear in the curriculum content and supporting materials. - Negative keywords observed: explicit project-based learning dominance, STEM-first framing, or replacing history with social studies terminology are not evidenced in the school’s public materials; the lexicon notes such signals as negative in the broader classical lexicon, but not in the Holy Innocents site. (Rubric reference for negative indicators: Six Essential Elements lexicon.)

Why this rating - The curriculum is clearly anchored in liberal arts and the great books tradition (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin; Great Works; Western Civilization), with explicit references to upper- and lower-level classical courses. This strongly supports CLASSICAL rather than SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL or NOT CLASSICAL, given the explicit canonical and scholastic-curriculum framing.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical life includes a blend of contemplative and rigorous elements: singing, memorization, and contemplative experiences in lower grades; Socratic-style discussion, seminars, and debates in upper grades; and rhetoric training with opportunities to give speeches. The site notes a balance of rest and rigor and a progression from memory-based, chant/memory work to rhetorical discourse and public speaking. - The upper grades employ rhetoric and debate (Rhetoric II, Rhetoric IV) and public speaking, which aligns with classical pedagogy. - The lower grades emphasize singing, chanting, and memorization as memory-deepening and joy-filled activities, which mirrors scholé and contemplative pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: contemplation/scholé, singing/chanting, memory-work, moral formation, Socratic seminar (the site explicitly references upper-grade rhetoric and debates; lower-grade chant/memorization is described). Words such as “Socratic,” “seminar,” “debate,” “recollection/memory,” “chant,” “recitation,” and “public speaking” appear in public materials. - Negative keywords observed: the public site does not emphasize purely experiential-only or project-based pedagogy as its sole approach; the classical lexicon lists these as negative in some contexts, but the site demonstrates a mixed approach with Socratic and rhetorical elements rather than a purely project-based emphasis. (Rubric negative signals from the lexicon.)

Why this rating - The pedagogy demonstrates a deliberate balance of contemplative and discursive methods, with lower-grade activities that cultivate memory and reverence and upper-grade seminars and speaking. This aligns with CLASSICAL expectations more than with a strictly project-based or purely information-transmission approach.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site describes faculty as devoted and central to formation, with statements about “devoted faculty and staff” and the faculty being central to formation. Materials emphasize mentorship, living curriculum, and a community of teachers who model virtue. - The school presents teachers as an extension of the curriculum—the “living curriculum”—and highlights portrait/vision of teacher as mentor and core community. While explicit phrases like “portrait of a teacher” or “faculty of friends” appear in the classical lexicon, the Holy Innocents site communicates a culture of virtuous, skilled, and collaborative educators. - Collaboration and warmth within the faculty are implied through statements about partnership with parents and the role of faculty in moral and intellectual formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: devoted faculty and staff, living curriculum, teacher as mentor, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, character formation, moral exemplars. The site communicates a culture in which teachers embody and transmit the school’s classical aims. - Negative keywords observed: explicit negative indicators (e.g., certification-driven jargon without classical context, or purely technocratic teaching models) are not evident in public materials. (Rubric negative signals are described in the lexicon as potential pitfalls; the school site does not foreground these.)

Why this rating - The public materials consistently position faculty as central to the school’s mission, with a focus on character formation and mentorship, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations. The concept of the faculty as “living curriculum” is echoed by the school’s emphasis on close teacher-student relationships and virtue modeling.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly frames parents as partners and co-teachers, with a mission to educate parents and engage them in classical education (parent formation, book studies, gatherings). The site notes

that parents are welcome to visit and participate. Campaigns and events also indicate active parental and community involvement. - There are explicit channels for parental involvement (handbook access, open campus, parent formation opportunities) and regular community events (gala, campaigns, and outreach). - The school's communications emphasize partnership with families and the notion of the school-family community working together toward formation of students.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, family involvement, home-school partnership, parent book clubs, open campus, community of learners, school-parent synergy. These appear in the public materials. - Negative keywords observed: none evident; the site frames parental involvement positively and comprehensively, with no signals of treating parents as customers or minimizing parent engagement. (Rubric negative signals from the lexicon exist, but are not reflected in the public site content.)

Why this rating - The school presents a strong, explicit model of parent partnership and community engagement, consistent with classical education expectations about parents as co-educators and stakeholders in the formation process. The presence of parent formation activities, book clubs, open-campus access, and collaborative events supports a CLASSICAL designation.

What Would Move the Needle

Not applicable in this case, as the aggregate rating is CLASSICAL.

If the school sought to push toward a more purely "SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL" designation, potential needle-moving steps could include: - More explicit articulation of Socratic seminars and living-lecture formats across all grade levels (K–12) with clear rubrics and public examples. - A more explicit emphasis on great books and canonical texts across all disciplines, with posted reading lists and discussion frameworks for parents to engage at home.

(Notes above are not required for a CLASSICAL aggregate rating but provided as points of potential growth if the school desires to emphasize additional classical elements.)

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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